GE 4120

Midterm Group Reporting Mechanics

GROUP REPORTING OVERVIEW

Each group will present their assigned Google Workspace application through an interactive and informative report. The presentation should clearly demonstrate the group's understanding of the application, its features, and its practical uses.

REPORTING FLOW

1. Interactive Activity
Conduct a short, engaging activity related to the assigned application.

2. Discussion
Explain the application, including its purpose, features, and functions.

3. Demonstration
Show the proper use of the application through a live demonstration.

4. **Quiz / Assessment**
Conduct a short quiz to assess the audience's understanding.

1. ACTIVITY (kahoot etc.)
2. DISCUSSION (explain the app, purpose, features and functions)
3. DEMONSTRATION (show the proper use of the application through live demo)
4. Quiz (short quiz)

DISCUSSION CONTENT

WHAT IS GOOGLE DOCS?	Google Docs is an online word processor that allows users to create, edit, format, organize, share, and collaborate on documents. It is part of the Google Workspace ecosystem and is available through the web as well as Android and iOS applications. Unlike a traditional word-processing workflow in which one person creates a file locally and sends copies to other people, Google Docs is designed around cloud-based access and collaboration. **Simple definition** Google Docs is a cloud-based word-processing application for creating, editing, formatting, organizing, collaborating on, reviewing, and sharing digital documents. **Examples of documents that can be created** **Academic:** ● Research papers ● Reaction papers ● Essays ● Case studies ● Laboratory reports ● Group reports ● Study guides ● Thesis-related documents **Professional:** ● Reports ● Proposals ● Meeting agendas ● Meeting minutes ● Project documentation ● Business letters ● Training materials ● Policies and procedures **Personal:** ● Resumes ● Applications ● Personal plans ● Lists ● Journals

	• Invitations
WHY IS GOOGLE DOCS RELEVANT TO 21ST-CENTURY IT SKILLS?	Twenty-first-century information technology is not limited to knowing how to type or format a document. Modern users are also expected to know how to: **create → communicate → collaborate → organize information → manage revisions → protect information → share information digitally** Google Docs brings many of these skills together in one platform. For example, a student working on a group research paper can: 1. Create the document. 2. Give it a meaningful file name. 3. Organize it with headings. 4. Add a table of contents. 5. Insert tables, images, and links. 6. Give group members appropriate access. 7. Work simultaneously with classmates. 8. Leave comments. 9. Suggest edits instead of directly changing another person's work. 10. Track previous versions. 11. Add citations and a bibliography. 12. Download the finished document as another file format. This means that learning Google Docs is not simply learning where buttons are located. It is learning a **digital workflow for producing and managing information.**
GOOGLE DOCS INSIDE GOOGLE WORKSPACE	Google Docs should also be understood as one component of the larger Google Workspace environment. A simple way to explain the relationship is: **Google Drive** = file storage and organization **Google Docs** = documents and word processing **Google Sheets** = spreadsheets and numerical/data work **Google Slides** = presentations **Google Forms** = forms and data collection Google Docs becomes especially useful when it is connected with other Google Workspace tools. For example: **Google Calendar → meeting → Google Docs meeting notes → Google Drive storage → sharing/collaboration**

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>Google's current Workspace guidance specifically demonstrates how to use Docs for meeting agendas and notes, collaboration, comments, sharing, and other Workspace workflows.</td></tr>
<tr><td>MAIN PURPOSES OF GOOGLE DOCS</td><td>The purposes of Google Docs can be organized into six major categories:

<table><tr><th>PURPOSE</th><th>WHAT THE USER DOES</th></tr><tr><td>Create</td><td>Start a new document or use a template</td></tr><tr><td>Edit</td><td>Add, delete, move, or revise content</td></tr><tr><td>Format</td><td>Control appearance and document structure</td></tr><tr><td>Collaborate</td><td>Work with other people in the same document</td></tr><tr><td>Review</td><td>Comment, suggest changes, and track revisions</td></tr><tr><td>Distribute</td><td>Share, publish, download, print, or export the document</td></tr></table>
Important distinction:
A feature is what Google Docs provides. A function is what the user can accomplish with that feature.

For example:
Feature: Version history
Function: Allows users to review previous versions and restore an earlier version when appropriate.</td></tr>
<tr><td>CREATING AND ORGANIZING DOCUMENTS</td><td>Google Docs allows a user to create a blank document or start from a template. Google provides templates for common purposes, including CVs and other document types.

A new blank document can also be created through:
docs.google.com → Blank document

or directly through:
docs.new

Google's current documentation confirms both approaches.</td></tr>
</table>

	File naming A newly created document can be renamed simply by clicking the document name at the top and entering a new name. **Why naming matters** A proper filename makes documents easier to locate and manage. Poor naming: Untitled document Better naming: GE4120_Group3_GoogleDocs_Report Even better when dates or versions matter: GE4120_Group3_Report_Final_2026 A well-organized file name is a small but important digital information management skill.
EDITING TEXT	Google Docs provides the standard functions expected of a modern word processor. Users can: ● Type and edit text ● Delete or move content ● Copy and paste ● Undo and redo ● Change fonts ● Change font sizes ● Use bold, italic, underline, and strikethrough ● Change text and background colors ● Adjust alignment ● Change line and paragraph spacing ● Create numbered and bulleted lists ● Adjust indentation Google's documentation identifies these as core editing and formatting functions in Docs. **Why Formatting Matters** Formatting is not only decorative. It improves: **Readability → organization → emphasis → navigation → professionalism** For example:

	Instead of writing: Background Introduction Methodology Results Conclusion We can use heading styles: 1. Background 2. Introduction 3. Methodology 4. Results 5. Conclusion This makes the document easier for the reader to understand.
STYLES, HEADINGS, AND DOCUMENT STRUCTURE	One of the most important skills in Google Docs is understanding the difference between making text look large and actually assigning a heading style. Google Docs supports styles such as: ● Normal text ● Title ● Subtitle ● Heading 1 ● Heading 2 ● Heading 3 ● Heading 4 ● Heading 5 ● Heading 6 These styles can be used to build a logical document structure. **Why Headings are Important** Headings provide: Structure + navigation + accessibility + automatic table-of-contents support Google Docs can detect headings and use them in the document outline. For example: Heading 1: CHAPTER 1 – INTRODUCTION Heading 2: Background of the Study Heading 2: Statement of the Problem Heading 2:

	Significance of the Study Heading 1: CHAPTER 2 – REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE This is much better than manually bolding each section because Google Docs can understand the hierarchy.
DOCUMENT OUTLINE	The document outline displays the headings in a document and allows the user to navigate through the document more easily. Google Docs automatically detects headings for the outline. **Practical value** Imagine a 30-page research paper. Instead of scrolling from page 1 to page 30 looking for: Chapter 3 → Methodology → Research Design The user can open the document outline and jump directly to the heading. This is particularly useful for: ● Research papers ● Thesis documents ● Long reports ● Manuals ● Project documentation ● Study materials
TABLE OF CONTENTS	Google Docs can automatically generate a table of contents from the document's title and heading structure. Each entry links to the corresponding section of the document. **Why This Matters** A table of contents: ● Improves navigation ● Makes long documents easier to use ● Creates professional organization ● Reduces manual updating ● Connects document structure to navigation **Important Concept** The table of contents depends on proper heading styles. If you simply make text bold without applying Heading 1, Heading 2, etc., Google Docs does not necessarily treat that text as a document heading.
PAGES FORMAT VS.	A current Google Docs feature worth discussing is the

PAGELESS FORMAT	ability to choose between: **Pages** The document behaves more like a traditional printed document. You can use: ● Page breaks ● Headers ● Footers ● Page numbers ● Margins ● Paper size ● Page orientation **Pageless** The document becomes a continuously scrolling workspace rather than a traditional series of pages. Images can adjust to screen size, wide tables can extend horizontally, and text adjusts to the available screen width. **When should each be used?** **Pages:** research papers, formal reports, assignments, documents intended for printing. **Pageless:** collaborative notes, brainstorming, online planning, documents primarily intended for screen viewing. An important limitation is that several print-oriented features, including headers, footers, page numbers, and certain page settings, are unavailable in pageless format. (
INSERTING INFORMATION BEYOND PLAIN TEXT	Google Docs is not limited to paragraphs. Users can insert: ● Images ● Tables ● Charts ● Drawings ● Links ● Bookmarks ● Footnotes ● Headers and footers ● Page numbers ● Lists ● Other Google Workspace-related content Google's current Docs help materials document these content-insertion capabilities.

<table>
<tr>
<td>TABLES</td>
<td>Tables allow information to be organized into rows and columns.

For example:
<table>
<tr><th>GROUP MEMBERS</th><th>ASSIGNED TASK</th><th>DEADLINE</th><th>STATUS</th></tr>
<tr><td>Member 1</td><td>Introduction</td><td>Sept. 28</td><td>Done</td></tr>
<tr><td>Member 2</td><td>Features</td><td>Sept. 29</td><td>Ongoing</td></tr>
<tr><td>Member 3</td><td>Demonstration</td><td>Sept. 30</td><td>Not started</td></tr>
</table>

Google Docs supports adding and editing tables, and on computers users can also sort rows, move rows/columns, repeat header rows, and manage how table content flows across pages.

Practical Uses
Tables are useful for:
● Schedules
● Comparisons
● Project plans
● Meeting minutes
● Class activities
● Data summaries
● Checklists
● Organizational information</td>
</tr>
<tr>
<td>IMAGES AND VISUAL CONTENT</td>
<td>Images can be inserted into a Google Doc from several sources, including:
● Computer
● Stock/web sources
● Google Drive
● Google Photos
● Camera
● URL

Google's current documentation also supports adding cover images in pageless documents.

Practical Applications
Images can be used in:
● Instructional manuals
● Research reports
● Posters
● Project documentation
● Tutorials</td>
</tr>
</table>

	• Educational materials The important principle is: ***Visual elements should support the information rather than simply decorate the document.***
LINKS AND BOOKMARKS	Google Docs allows users to insert hyperlinks to websites, email addresses, and other destinations. It also supports bookmarks, which allow users to link directly to a particular location inside a document. This becomes very useful in long documents. For example: A project manual could contain: *Click here to go directly to the troubleshooting section.* The link can send the reader to a bookmarked section rather than forcing them to scroll through the entire document.
COLLABORATION	This is arguably the feature that most clearly distinguishes Google Docs from a basic offline document workflow. Google Docs allows documents to be shared with other people using different permission levels: **Viewer** Can view the document. **Commenter** Can view and comment and can make suggestions, but does not directly edit the document's content. **Editor** Can directly modify the document. Google's current sharing documentation identifies Viewer, Commenter, and Editor as the primary access roles. **Why this Matters** Suppose four students are preparing one research report. Traditional workflow: Student A writes → downloads file → sends file → Student B edits → sends another version → Student C edits → several files exist Possible result:

	Final.docx Final2.docx Final_REAL.docx Final_REAL_NEW.docx Final_USE_THIS_ONE.docx Google Docs changes that workflow. Instead: **One shared document → multiple authorized collaborators → one central working copy**
COMMENTS	Comments allow collaborators to discuss specific content without necessarily changing the document itself. Users can select text and add a comment. Other collaborators can reply to comments and resolve them when the discussion is finished. **Example** A student writes: The results were very significant. A group member can comment: “Can we add the statistical value or supporting source here?” The original writer can respond: “Yes. I will add the source.” Once completed, the comment can be resolved. **Why Comments are Useful** Comments separate: ***the document's content*** from ***the discussion about the content*** This makes group work cleaner and more organized.
ACTION ITEMS	Comments can also be used as **action items.** For eligible work or school accounts, a collaborator can be assigned a task through a comment, and the assigned person receives an email notification. Example: “@Maria, please verify the references.”

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>This converts a general discussion into a specific responsibility.

Practical value
This is particularly useful for:
● Group projects
● Business projects
● Meeting follow-ups
● Task assignment
● Document review</td></tr>
<tr><td>SUGGESTING MODE</td><td>Google Docs has a Suggesting mode that lets users propose changes without directly making those changes final.

Suggested additions and deletions appear differently from the document's accepted text, and the document owner can accept or reject each suggestion.

Why is this Important?
Imagine an editor reviewing a classmate's paragraph.

Instead of deleting the original sentence and replacing it permanently, the editor can suggest:
“Consider changing this sentence for clarity.”

The author retains control over whether the change becomes part of the final document.

Best Use
Suggesting mode is especially appropriate for:
● Peer editing
● Proofreading
● Academic writing
● Editorial work
● Supervisory review
● Draft revisions</td></tr>
<tr><td>COMMENTS VS SUGGESTIONS VS DIRECT EDITING</td><td><table>
<tr><th>METHOD</th><th>PURPOSE</th></tr>
<tr><td>Direct Editing</td><td>Make the change immediately.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Comment</td><td>Discuss, ask, explain, or assign a task.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Suggestion</td><td>Propose a change that another user can accept or reject.</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
</table>

	A strong way to remember it: Edit = change it. Comment = talk about it. Suggest = propose changing it.
VERSION HISTORY	Google Docs supports version history, allowing users with the appropriate access to review previous versions and see who made changes. Google's Workspace guidance explains that users with Owner or Editor access can open version history, inspect previous timestamps and contributors, and restore an earlier version when appropriate. Why Version History is Important Imagine that someone accidentally deletes an important paragraph. Instead of saying: “Who deleted it?” the group can investigate the document's previous versions. Version history supports: **accountability + revision tracking + recovery + collaboration** This is especially valuable for group projects.
AUTOMATIC SAVING	When working online, Google automatically saves changes as the user types, so there is no traditional Save button required. This is one of the major differences between a cloud-based editing workflow and the traditional: **Type → Save → Save As → Send attachment** workflow. However, automatic saving should not be confused with permission to share. A document can be safely saved but still incorrectly shared. Therefore: ***Saving protects the document from losing changes; sharing controls who can access the document.***
SMART CHIPS	A particularly useful modern Google Docs feature is the

	smart chip. Smart chips can provide contextual information for things such as: ● People ● Google files ● Dates ● Calendar events ● Places and directions Google Docs also supports other chip-based features such as placeholders, dropdowns, and time trackers. A simple way to activate many of these features is to type: **@** Example Typing: @Maria can create a people-related smart chip. Typing: @today can create a date chip. Typing: @ also opens a menu containing other items that can be inserted. **Important Security Concept** Mentioning a person in a smart chip **does not automatically give that person access to the document.** The document still needs to be shared with the appropriate permission. This is a very good example of why users should understand both **productivity features and access control.**
BUILDING BLOCKS	Google Docs currently provides building blocks designed to help users quickly create structured content for purposes such as: ● Project management ● Communication ● Meetings Examples include meeting notes and other reusable structures.

	The @ menu can also be used to locate building blocks. Practical Example Instead of manually creating a project-tracking layout every time, a group can insert a suitable building block and immediately begin adding project information. This supports the principle: **Use templates and reusable structures when the goal is efficiency and consistency.** Eligible work or school accounts may also have access to custom building blocks.
DROPDOWNS AND STRUCTURED INFORMATION	Google Docs can also use dropdown chips to display multiple status options. For Example **Status:** ● Not Started ● In Progress ● For Review ● Completed
CITATIONS AND BIBLIOGRAPHY	For academic work, one of the most useful features is the Citations tool. Google Docs currently supports citation styles including: ● MLA 8th edition ● APA 7th edition ● Chicago Author-Date 17th edition The citation tool is accessed through: **Tools → Citations** **Why this matters to students** Instead of manually typing every citation, users can store source information and use Google's citation workflow. This is especially useful for: ● Research papers ● Literature reviews ● Reports ● Essays ● Academic projects However: A citation tool does not eliminate the need to verify whether a source is accurate, appropriate, and correctly represented.

	Technology assists with formatting; the researcher remains responsible for the quality and integrity of the information.
WORD COUNT	Google Docs includes a word-count function that can display: ● Pages ● Words ● Characters ● Characters without spaces The user can also choose to display the count while typing. **Practical example** If an instructor says: “Submit a 1,500-word essay.” The student can monitor progress directly in Google Docs rather than estimating manually.
SPELLING AND GRAMMAR CHECKING	Google Docs provides spelling and grammar suggestions that users can accept or ignore. In supported languages, misspellings and grammar suggestions can appear directly in the document. **Important Principle** The feature is an aid—not a substitute for proofreading. A grammatically acceptable sentence can still contain: ● Incorrect facts ● Poor reasoning ● Wrong terminology ● Misleading statements ● Improper citations Therefore: **Google Docs can help improve writing mechanics, but the user remains responsible for the content.**
VOICE TYPING	Google Docs also supports **voice typing,** allowing users to dictate text using a microphone. Google currently documents support in recent versions of Chrome, Edge, and Safari, although availability can depend on organizational settings. **Practical Applications** Voice typing can help when: ● Drafting ideas quickly ● Taking notes ● Supporting accessibility

	● Creating spoken drafts ● Reducing repetitive typing
COMPATIBILITY WITH MICROSOFT OFFICE FILES	Google Docs can also work with Microsoft Office files in Google Drive. Users can upload Office files and work with them through Google Docs, Sheets, or Slides, or convert them to Google formats. This matters because modern workplaces often contain files created by different software ecosystems. Therefore, digital literacy includes knowing how to work across file formats rather than assuming everyone uses the same application.
EXPORTING AND DOWNLOADING DOCUMENTS	A Google Doc can be downloaded into other file formats through: **File → Download** Google's documentation confirms downloading documents in different formats and also provides PDF-saving options through printing. **Practical example** A group may: **Collaborate in Google Docs → finalize the document → download as PDF → submit the PDF** This separates the **working format** from the **submission format.**
PRIVACY AND SHARING	One of the most important digital-literacy lessons in Google Docs is: *Do not confuse "having a link" with "having the correct permission."* Google Docs sharing can use: Restricted, Anyone with the link with roles such as: Viewer / Commenter / Editor For schoolwork, the safest general approach is to give people only the access they actually need. For example: Group members → Editor Instructor reviewing a draft → Commenter or Editor, depending on requirements

	Class audience receiving a finished copy → Viewer Google also provides settings that can limit downloading, printing, and copying for viewers and commenters, although such controls do not prevent someone from sharing content through other means.
AI AND GEMINI IN GOOGLE DOCS	An important current development is the integration of Gemini into Google Docs. Google describes Gemini in Docs as an AI assistant that can help with tasks such as drafting content, improving writing, summarizing information, and related document tasks. These capabilities require an eligible Google Workspace or Google AI plan, so availability is not identical for every account. Google's current Workspace material also demonstrates Gemini-assisted document creation and refinement. **Responsible use of AI** AI should be treated as an assistance tool, not an automatic source of truth. A good workflow is: **AI suggestion → human review → fact checking → editing → final decision** This is particularly important for academic work.
KEY TAKEAWAY	Google Docs combines traditional word-processing functions with modern cloud-based collaboration. Its most important categories can be remembered as: **CREATE** **EDIT** **FORMAT** **ORGANIZE** **COLLABORATE** **REVIEW** **MANAGE** **SHARE** The greatest value of Google Docs comes from using these functions together rather than treating each feature as an isolated button.